

Retirement and Savings Plan Guide

Policy ID	HR-BEN-202	Owner	Total Rewards
Effective	January 1, 2026	Next review	January 1, 2027
Status	Current	Classification	Internal
Audience	Eligible employees	Company	Northstar Technologies (fictional)

Document notice: This policy is fictional and was created for retrieval-augmented generation testing. It is not legal, tax, medical, or employment advice.

1. Purpose and Scope

This guide summarizes participation, employee contributions, company matching, vesting, beneficiary elections, loans, and separation rules for the fictional Northstar Savings Plan. The formal plan document controls in all cases.

This policy applies across company offices and approved remote locations unless a local addendum or controlling law provides a different rule. Employees should use the current policy version and ask the listed owner when facts do not fit the standard case.

2. Summary of Key Rules

Feature	Standard rule	Important exception
Employee contributions	Eligible on first payroll	Payroll cutoff may delay first deduction
Company match	100% of first 4%	Begins after 90 days of service
Vesting	Immediate for employee funds	Company match vests after 2 years
Beneficiary	Employee election	Local marital-consent rules may apply

3. Enrollment and Contributions

Eligible employees may enroll or change contribution percentages through the plan portal. Elections received after the payroll cutoff take effect in the next practicable cycle. Contribution limits follow applicable law and may change each year. The plan administrator may return excess contributions when required.

4. Company Match

After 90 days of service, the company matches 100 percent of eligible employee contributions up to four percent of eligible pay. Contributions above four percent do not receive an additional company match. Bonuses may be excluded from eligible pay under the formal plan document. The match is calculated each payroll and may be reconciled after year-end.

5. Vesting, Loans, and Hardship

Employee contributions are always fully vested. Company matching contributions vest after two years of credited service. Eligible participants may request a loan or hardship distribution through the plan administrator, subject to plan limits, documentation, fees, and tax consequences. People Operations cannot provide personal tax or investment advice.

6. Leave and Separation

Contributions generally stop when there is no eligible pay. Loan payments may require a separate arrangement during unpaid leave. At separation, participants may leave funds in the plan if eligible, roll them to another qualified account, or request a distribution. Small balances may be handled under automatic distribution rules in the formal plan document.

7. Exceptions, Records, and Questions

Exceptions must be lawful, documented, limited in duration, and approved by the policy owner plus any other owner named in the relevant section. Approval for one case does not change the policy for other employees. Records are retained according to the company retention schedule and any legal hold.

Related documents: Benefits Eligibility and Enrollment Guide; Payroll Calendar and Cutoffs Policy; Offboarding and Company Property Return Policy.

Version history

Version	Effective date	Change
1.0	January 1, 2026	Initial fictional policy issued for RAG evaluation.